

Session 9: The Relationship Between Genesis 1 and 2

Key Takeaways

- Genesis 1 introduces us to God's ideal for creation, and Genesis 2 introduces the characters who will be given the chance to live out that ideal.
- The importance of historicity questions changes when you prioritize the message of the story.

The Genesis 1 Ideal

Genesis 1 offers the ideal portrait of creation with humans imaging God. It is the cosmic set up that precedes [Genesis 2:4](#).

Psalm 8 as a Genesis 1 Reflection

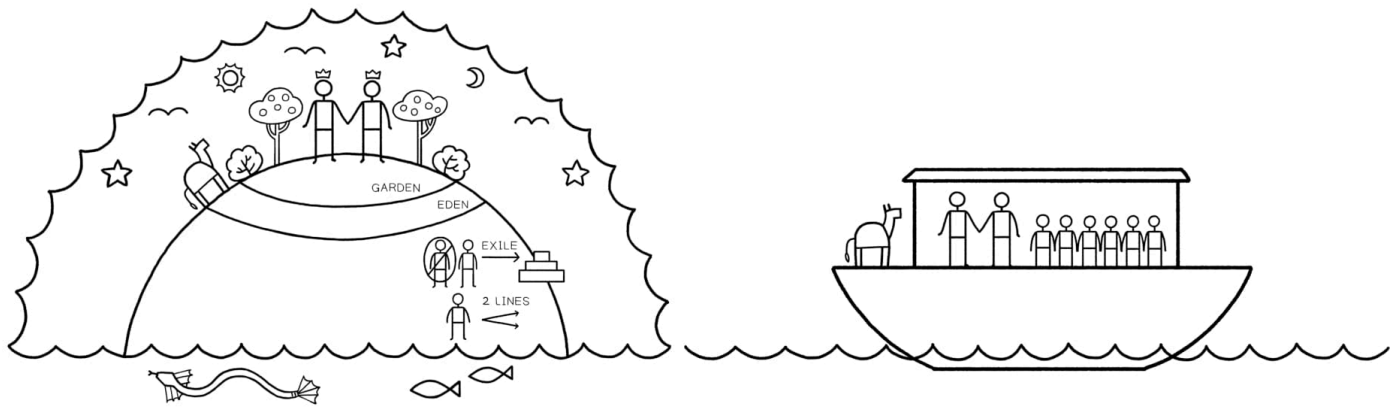
This portrait of humans as divine and royal image of Yahweh is precisely the claim of [Psalm 8](#), which is the product of a sustained meditation on Genesis 1.

Genesis 1 and the later reflection in [Psalm 8](#) give us the whole story of humanity in one opening movement. It functions as the ideal portrait of creation, and Genesis 2:4 is the hinge that gets us into reality.

Apostles Reflect on Psalm 8

The author of Hebrews has clearly meditated on both Genesis 1 and Psalm 8. In [Hebrews 2:5](#), the author nods to the unfulfilled ideal that was finally realized through the crucifixion and resurrection of Jesus.

View 3: Tim's Merger View



IDEAL

GEN 1



2:4

REALITY

GEN 2:4b...

Tim's View on the Relationship Between Genesis 1 and 2. Illustration created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Adam to Noah (2020).

Reflection Question

How do Genesis 1 and 2 relate to one other? How would you describe the different purpose of each chapter?